

STARTUP TIMES

Volume 01 Issue 03
May 2024



**A Quarterly E-Magazine from
Kerala Startup Mission**

Kerala has around 5400+ startups working in various sectors spread across its 14 districts. Our startups work in wide range of sectors including Artificial Intelligence, Hardware, Healthcare, Fin tech, Bio Technology etc.


K E R A L A
STARTUP MISSION®



WORLD CLASS INFRASTRUCTURE TO ACCELERATE YOUR GROWTH

10 Lakh Sq. ft across the
state to handhold the
startups in their
entrepreneurial journey

5400+
STARTUPS

04
ACCELERATORS

63
INCUBATORS

463
MINI INCUBATORS

5800CR
VC & ANGEL FUNDING

25CR
INNOVATION GRANT

50000
EMPLOYMENT GENERATED

40000+
ASPIRING ENTREPRENEURS

61CR
FUND OF FUND



***AS A STARTUP, YOU MUST
GO AFTER MONEY WHICH
UNDERSTANDS THE
BUSINESS"***

**SACHIN BANSAL
FLIPKART**

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FROM THE CEO'S DESK



Anoop Ambika
CEO
KERALA STARTUP MISSION

Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) continues to champion innovation, diversity, and entrepreneurship in Kerala's vibrant startup ecosystem. The recent recognition as the 'Best Performer' at the States' Startup Ranking 2022 underscores our commitment in supporting startups, students, and women entrepreneurs with essential resources and mentorship.

Our efforts to promote gender equality through initiatives like seed loans and innovation grants for women entrepreneurs, providing extended moratorium periods and additional grants to foster their success have created excellent results. These led to over 5,400 startups registering in Kerala, with a significant focus on sectors like renewable energy, eco-sustainability, and agriculture, contributing to the state's overall growth.

KSUM's dedication to nurturing young talent is evident through our incubation centers which have been recently rebranded as LEAP Coworks, providing startups with state-of-the-art infrastructure and a dynamic community for collaboration. Leap centers were started in Kollam, Kasargod and are currently expanding to six other districts. Our global outreach includes incubation centers (Startup Infinity Centers) in Dubai, Belgium, and Australia, facilitating access to foreign markets for our startups.

We're actively fostering a culture of entrepreneurship through initiatives like Research Innovation Network Kerala (RINK), Incubation and Entrepreneurship Development Centers (IEDCs) and Fab Lab Kerala Network.

We're currently progressing with Fab Academy 2024, a globally conducted, 6-month-long, intensive digital fabrication course organized by the Fab Foundation and led by Neil Gershenfeld, Director of MIT's Center for Bits and Atoms. Participants engage in hands-on learning, designing, and prototyping advanced projects, with additional sessions by renowned experts from diverse global locations. Upon completing Fab Academy, participants can explore diverse career prospects, including various roles in product development and design, opportunities in Fablabs worldwide, positions in research facilities like IITs, and collaborations on MIT and Fab Foundation projects. Graduates also have opportunities for internships and fellowships at Fablab Kerala.

KSUM's commitment to nurturing young talent is evident through our expanding network of Incubation and Entrepreneurship Development Centers (IEDCs), which has now grown across 481 institutions in Kerala. KSUM is also planning

to introduce IEDCs in medical colleges. Concurrently, we are also working on incorporating an entrepreneurship - focused syllabus in educational institutions across Kerala. These strategic initiatives aim to cultivate a culture of innovation and entrepreneurship among students, equipping them with the skills and mindset to become future leaders and innovators in Kerala's dynamic startup ecosystem.

We also had the opportunity to unveil the visionary AVGC-XR policy aimed at establishing the state as a global hub in the AVGC-XR (Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming and Comics and Extended Reality) sector, at FICCI frames Mumbai. The policy aims to create 50,000 jobs and facilitate 250 firms, including multinational companies, by 2029. The policy also aims to integrate AVGC-XR technologies into academic programmes, establish AVGC-XR parks and labs for digital content production, and set up a Centre of Excellence (CoE) in AVGC-XR for talent development, innovation, and R&D.

As part of the deliberations on the proposed emerging technology hub, named #Future, KSUM will be accelerating the deployment of next generation technologies in 5 sectors; Space Technology, Healthcare and Life Sciences, Food & Agriculture, Digital Media and Entertainment and Renewable Energy with a sector agnostic focus on Sustainability.

Looking ahead, Our vision is to elevate Kerala's startup ecosystem to a global level of excellence, attracting large companies and fostering continued growth and prosperity, all while continuing to evolve ourselves with the global technology landscape.



STARTUP IN FOCUS

Riafy Technologies: A Trailblazer in Artificial Intelligence

In the bustling city of Kochi, India, amidst a landscape of tech-driven enterprises, Riafy Technologies has carved out a niche as a leading force in artificial intelligence. Founded by a group of six visionary individuals, John Mathew, Joseph Babu, Neeraj Manoharan, K.V. Sreenath, Benny Xavier, and Benoy Joseph—Riafy has grown to become a global powerhouse in AI, captivating a user base of over 75 million people across 23 languages.

Riafy's inception was marked by the development of an innovative AI-based system, laying the groundwork for their patented AI technology, RIA. The collaborative efforts of the six founders, each bringing unique skills and perspectives, have been pivotal in shaping Riafy's trajectory in the AI industry.



The company's strategic partnerships have played a crucial role in its success. As the premium generative AI partner of Google Cloud, Riafy has leveraged this collaboration to expand its reach and capabilities. Additionally, partnerships with leading banking institutions like Federal Bank, Karur Vysya Bank, and ICICI Bank have allowed Riafy to develop cutting-edge Conversational AI Assistants, enhancing customer service and streamlining operations.



One of Riafy's groundbreaking initiatives is its collaboration with IndiGo Airlines, resulting in the creation of 6ESkai—an innovative AI platform on WhatsApp. This platform revolutionizes the ticket booking process by offering seamless, user-friendly interactions and ethical AI integration, catering to passengers in their native language.

Beyond technological innovation, Riafy has demonstrated a strong commitment to societal well-being. During the devastating Kerala floods in 2018, Riafy's AI system played a crucial role in saving 36,000 lives by transforming physical addresses into mappable coordinates, aiding rescue efforts significantly. Amid the global pandemic in 2020, Riafy once again showcased its humanitarian spirit by establishing an AI ambulance network recognized as a Digital Public Good by the UN, facilitating the efficient transport of COVID patients to Care Facilities across 11 Indian states.

Under its R10 brand, Riafy has diversified its portfolio to include a wide range of generative AI products catering to various sectors, from banking and aviation to healthcare and retail. These tailored solutions have garnered widespread acclaim and are utilized by millions worldwide.



Riafy's unwavering commitment to Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) was recently recognized with the Google Cloud Partner of the Year 2024 award for the Asia Pacific (APAC) region. CEO John Mathew accepted this esteemed award at the Google Cloud Next '24 event in Las Vegas, underscoring Riafy's dedication to fostering an inclusive work environment and promoting diversity in the tech industry.

As Riafy Technologies continues to innovate and expand its global footprint, the company remains anchored in its core values of compassion, integrity, and inclusivity. With a legacy of impactful projects, strategic partnerships, and a bright future ahead, Riafy is not only shaping the future of AI but also making a meaningful difference in the lives of people around the world.

Website: <https://riafy.me/tech/>

A VISUAL ROUND-UP

Kerala: 'Best Performer State' in India's Startup Ecosystem for 2022

Kerala has earned the esteemed title of 'Best Performer State' in the Startup India Rankings for 2022, facilitated by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT). This prestigious recognition is a testament to Kerala's continuous efforts in establishing a strong and dynamic startup ecosystem.

Kerala's innovative strategies and unique approaches have set it apart as a leader in capacity building, setting a high standard for other states. It has become a major player in funding, thanks to its proactive and strategic approach to procurement.

The state also actively promotes sustainable practices within its startup community and beyond, setting an example for responsible entrepreneurship. It has become a hub for incubation, providing support to young businesses and helping them grow and reach their potential.



Kerala has significantly contributed to guiding startups through their journeys as a mentorship champion, providing invaluable advice. Its creative and visionary leadership has been a model for other states.

Kerala has created a favorable environment for startups to thrive as an institutional champion. The state's commitment to promoting innovation, fostering creativity, and encouraging inclusive growth has solidified its position as a key startup destination in India.

Launch of Kerala's First Campus Industrial Park & ZOHO R&D LABS

Kerala's first Industrial Park at a campus, supported by Kerala Startup Mission, Zoho, and IHRD, was opened by Kerala's Chief Minister, Shri Pinarayi Vijayan, at the College of Engineering IHRD, Kottarakkara on February 19, 2024. Finance Minister Shri K. N. Balagopal called this a groundbreaking step for Kerala's industry. Other important guests included Higher Education and Social Justice Minister Dr. R Bindu, IT Secretary Dr. Rathan U Kelkar, Zoho's founder Shri Sridhar Vembu, Co-founder Tony Thomas, IHRD Director Dr Arun Kumar, and Kerala Startup Mission CEO Shri Anoop Ambika.





Launch of Leap Co-Works Centre, Kannur

Kerala Startup Mission's LEAP Co-Works Centre Kannur was officially inaugurated by Shri TV Rajesh, Chairman of KCCPL, at MiZone, Kannur on 23 February 2024. Shri Anoop Ambika, CEO of Mission exchanged MoU regarding LEAP Co-Works Centre Kannur with Shri TV Rajesh. Distinguished guests including Shri Anakai Balakrishnan - Managing Director of KCCPL, Shri Shilen Sugunan-Chairman of Mizone, Dr A Madhavan - CEO of Mizone, and Shri Subhash Babu-Director of Mizone graced the occasion with their esteemed presence.



STARTUP INDIA WORKSHOP

Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) recently hosted the 5th edition of the State Startup Ranking Framework, featuring a Knowledge Exchange Workshop (Kerala Edition) organized by Startup India. The event aimed to foster startup ecosystems and collaboration among states to boost economic development through startups. The workshop provided representatives from various states with effective strategies for nurturing their startup ecosystems.



Launch of Satellite Centre of Ernakulam Public Library In KSUM, Kochi

The Satellite Center of Ernakulam Public Library was inaugurated by Shri TD Ramakrishnan, renowned novelist and literary figure at Integrated Startup Complex, KSUM, Kochi, on 27th February 2024. The center provides a range of resources and services, enhancing the entrepreneurial environment at KSUM. This collaboration brings knowledge and innovation together, allowing patrons to access a wealth of resources and services, further enriching the entrepreneurial ecosystem.



Women in STEM and Entrepreneurship Leaders Program hosted by British High Commission and KSUM with University of Oxford and Chevening Alumni

In Kochi, they hosted a program called Women in STEM and Entrepreneurship Leaders Program. This event was a joint effort with the British High Commission, the University of Oxford, and the Chevening Alumni. Their aim was to get more women involved in Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics (STEM). The event was more than just networking. It was about showcasing the important role of women in STEM and their work in bringing new ideas. People from different backgrounds attended, including new scientists and experienced entrepreneurs. They shared their thoughts and learned from each other. Through these discussions, the attendees learned from real-life experiences.

They got insights on how to deal with challenges and celebrate wins with leaders in STEM. The event was inspiring and gave a path forward for those wanting to work in these important sectors. By hosting this event, they want to break down barriers and create a place where everyone is treated equally. Their goal is to create a future where everyone, regardless of their gender, can succeed in STEM fields. They believe that the women in STEM will continue to make important contributions to the world. They are excited for the great work and new ideas that will come from the talented people who attended this event. Together, they are working towards a bright and inclusive future where everyone is welcomed and equality is the norm in the pursuit of scientific excellence.



Fab Academy 2024 began in fine fashion at Super Fablab Kochi

The Fab Academy, known for its diverse and inclusive environment, takes a leap forward this year. In a remarkable departure from previous years, half of its candidates are women, each a recipient of the Women Maker Scholarship. This initiative is generously offered by the Kerala Startup Mission, aiming to promote gender equality in the field of innovation. The students hail from a wide array of academic backgrounds, adding to the richness and diversity of ideas and perspectives within the academy. At Fablab Kerala, the goal is not merely imparting education. Through the Fab Academy, they are nurturing a new generation of innovators who will contribute significantly to the transformation of the state. Their ultimate vision is to aid Kerala's journey to become a Knowledge Economy.

By fostering a culture of innovation and creativity, they are creating a pipeline of talented creators and thinkers. This, they believe, will make a significant impact on the state's transition into a robust Knowledge Economy.



Kerala Startup Mission Hosts Visit by MeitY Delegation



Kerala Startup Mission was pleased to welcome Shri S Krishnan, IAS, Secretary to the Government of India, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), and his delegation. The delegation visited Integrated Startup Complex (ISC) in Kochi, which was a moment of great honor for them. This visit represented a meeting of ideas and innovation, showing the successful cooperation between the Ministry and Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM), emphasizing their mutual goal to support the growing startup community. They are excited about the future and look forward to deepening their relationship, working together for progress in the field of electronics and information technology.

Innovation Tour

The Innovation Tour is a monthly event for innovators, organized by Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM). It takes place on the first Saturday of each month. Below are some highlights from the event held at the KSUM Kochi Campus from January to March. This event serves as a platform for entrepreneurs with innovative business ideas. They can learn about the various programs and resources that KSUM offers to support their startups.



The Innovation Tour at KSUM Trivandrum takes place on the third Saturday of each month. Participants could engage in interactive discussions, gaining a deeper understanding of the startup ecosystem and the support available through KSUM. They could also explore the Fablab at the space and inspire attendees with innovative possibilities.



Kerala Startup Mission Hosts US Trade Education Mission

Kerala Startup Mission was honored to host distinguished representatives from the US Trade Education Mission. Esteemed representatives from the US Consulate and officials from 18 renowned US universities also attended the event at KSUM, Kochi. The visit underscored the importance of international partnerships in promoting entrepreneurship and innovation.



International Women's Day Celebration at KSUM, Trivandrum and LEAP Coworks, Palakkad

Glimpses from the International Women's Day celebrations at LEAP Trivandrum with their amazing startups and a special guest speaker, Ms. Kabani Civic, Deputy Collector, Land Revenue Dept, Trivandrum. Ms Kabani IAS delivered a captivating session on "Womanhood and the Stories of Struggled Women," sparking inspiring discussions and activities.



Kerala Startup Mission's Leap CoWorks Centre in Palakkad celebrated International Women's Day, highlighting the significant contributions of women to Kerala's startup landscape and KSUM's commitment to gender equality and inclusivity



WeStart Virtual Pre Incubation program

The WEStart program, designed for women entrepreneurs, has concluded after three months of intensive training and mentorship. The program provided guidance on essential aspects of the entrepreneurial journey, from laying strong business foundations to mastering product development. Participants from diverse backgrounds exchanged valuable insights and shared experiences, forming meaningful connections that will continue to enrich their entrepreneurial endeavors. The program celebrates the achievements and growth of each participant.



WOMEN STARTUP IN FOCUS

Prophaze WAF 3.0: A Comprehensive Approach to Web and API Security

Established in 2019, Prophaze Technologies has rapidly risen to prominence as a leader in cybersecurity solutions. The company's journey has been marked by significant milestones, including securing over 1,000 applications and managing more than 300 million requests daily. This rapid growth and expertise have earned Prophaze industry recognition as an "Innovation Leader in Web Application Firewall (WAF)" by KuppingerCole Analysis and the "Most Innovative Product of the Year 2022" award from DSCI.

Beyond private sector accomplishments, Prophaze has successfully collaborated with government entities on critical projects. Notably, the company has partnered with the Kerala State Government for eHealth and Treasury/Finance Department initiatives, as well as providing cybersecurity solutions for the Anand Parbat Military Station. These partnerships underscore Prophaze's versatility and ability to meet the stringent security requirements of diverse sectors.

Prophaze Technologies stands out in the cybersecurity landscape with its cloud-native architecture and AI/ML-based threat profiling. Offering a unified WAF solution across Multi-Cloud, Hybrid Cloud, and On-Premises environments, Prophaze ensures robust protection for its clients. The company's focus on low false positives, easy onboarding, and a low total cost of ownership further enhances its appeal to businesses seeking reliable cybersecurity solutions.



LAKSHMI DAS
CO FOUNDER

In response to the evolving technology landscape, Prophaze adopts a forward-thinking approach to cybersecurity. The company seamlessly integrates with DevOps to embed security in the application lifecycle and offers granular control and visibility for API security. With advanced alerting systems and adaptable WAF instances, Prophaze is well-equipped to detect and mitigate Layer 7 DDoS attacks and other emerging threats.

Looking ahead, Prophaze is poised to capitalize on the increasing adoption of cloud-native architectures, IoT devices, and remote work. The company plans to enhance its AI-driven threat detection capabilities, bolster API security, and expand its reach into emerging markets. With adaptability at its core, Prophaze remains committed to staying ahead of emerging threats and safeguarding its clients' digital assets.

Beyond its technological innovations, Prophaze is dedicated to promoting cybersecurity awareness through thought leadership and strategic partnerships. By educating businesses and individuals about the importance of cybersecurity, Prophaze aims to create a safer and more secure digital ecosystem for all.

Website: <https://prophaze.com/>

KERALA'S AVGC-XR POLICY: A GAME-CHANGER FOR DIGITAL CREATIVITY



Shri Anoop Ambika, CEO of Kerala Startup Mission, Shri Jayakumar, CEO of Toonz Animation, and Shri Jayaraj G, Director of CDIT during Ficci Frames 2024 unveiling the Kerala AVGC-XR Policy

The Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming, Comics, and Extended Reality (AVGC-XR) sector in Kerala is set to receive a significant boost with the unveiling of a comprehensive policy aimed at fostering its growth. Proposed by the Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM), the policy targets ambitious goals, including capturing at least 10% of the country's AVGC-XR-based product and service exports and creating 50,000 jobs in the sector by 2029.

The policy is being supported by various agencies such as Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM), KSIDC, KSFDC, Kerala Digital University, C-DIT, Kerala Fibre Optic Network (K-FON), Kerala Development and Innovation Strategic Council (K-DISC) and Kerala Knowledge Economy Mission.

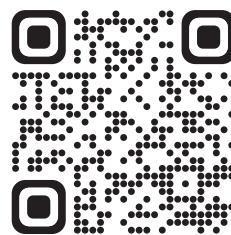
At its core, the policy focuses on infrastructure development with plans to establish state-of-the-art AVGC-XR Parks and Labs. A Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Thiruvananthapuram will serve as the hub for talent development and innovation, supported by agencies like KSIDC, KSFDC, Kerala Digital University, and Kerala Fibre Optic Network (K-FON).

The policy leverages Kerala's robust digital infrastructure, including the high-speed internet provided by K-FON, to integrate AVGC-XR technologies into academic programs from school to college levels. New courses will cover a broad spectrum of subjects, from Animation and Visual Effects to e-Sports and VR Marketing, with qualified professionals serving as 'Professors of Practice' to lead these programs.

Financial incentives and support for startups aim to establish 250 AVGC-XR companies and produce 10,000 industry-ready professionals. With a goal to account for 15% of the country's AVGC content, the policy offers a comprehensive roadmap to position Kerala as a global leader in AVGC-XR.

As the policy nears finalization, public feedback is sought to ensure alignment with industry needs. Supported by a collaborative effort from various agencies, Kerala's AVGC-XR Policy promises to unlock unprecedented opportunities, fostering a vibrant digital creative ecosystem.

To know more, visit <https://www.avgcpolicy.startupmission.in>



FOUNDERS MEET: 15TH EDITION

The 15th edition of Founders Meet, held on 12th January 2024 at Palakkad IIT, was a success, bringing together prominent startup figures to exchange ideas and experiences. Distinguished speakers, including Anoop Ambika (CEO of Kerala Startup Mission), A. Sheshadri Shekar (Director of Palakkad IIT), Ravindran P.M. (Managing Director of Palakkad Surgical Industries), Rahul P Balachandran (CEO of Inker Robotics), Rajesh Malamal (Ex-Co-founder of Watasale, CGO at Estro Tech Robotics), and Anoop Balakrishnan (Product Owner at Omnichannel Retail Bigbasket), shared invaluable insights. Attendees connected with industry leaders, gaining crucial insights for their startup journey. The event successfully culti-



vated a vibrant network of founders, providing a platform to navigate challenges across various stages of growth.

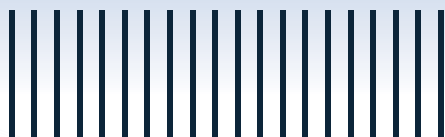
FOUNDERS MEET: 16TH EDITION

The 16th edition of Founders Meet, held on 23 February 2024 at Mizone Kannur was a success. Distinguished speakers, including Aronin Ponnappan, Cofounder & CEO of Sastra Robotics, Shilen Sagunan, Chief Executive of SS Consulting, Kochi and Anoop Ambika, CEO of Kerala Startup Mission, shared invaluable insights. Participants connected with industry leaders and cultivated a vibrant network of founders, providing a platform to navigate growth challenges.



FOUNDERS MEET: 17TH EDITION

Founders Meet 17.0 held on March 23, 2024, at St. Thomas College Ranni, Pathanamthitta, was a great success! Participants had the privilege of engaging with visionary leaders including Tim Mathews, Cofounder & CEO of Finsall Resources; Najeeb Bin Haneef, Founder & CEO of Zaara Biotech; and Anoop Ambika, CEO of Kerala Startup Mission. The event provided a platform for networking, idea exchange, and collaboration among founders.



FOUNDERS MEET: 18TH EDITION



The 18th Founders Meet in Calicut, which featured notable figures from the startup community, was an incredible event altogether. Everyone gained knowledge and expertise from the best, inspiring them to follow their entrepreneurial aspirations with passion.



FOUNDERS MEET: 19TH EDITION

The 19th edition of the Founders Meet in Kollam, moderated by Mr. Arun R S Chandran, Founder of Neonicz, featured insightful talks from industry leaders. Ms. Lakshmi Das, Co-Founder of Prophaze, emphasized innovation and resilience in cybersecurity. Mr. Raman M, Co-Founder and CEO of ChargeMOD, discussed the future of electric vehicle infrastructure, highlighting challenges and opportunities. Hari K S, Director of Cleomed Medical Systems, shared advancements in medical technology and the role of entrepreneurship in healthcare. The event also included an interactive segment, "Founder's Ask," where five startups pitched their products, gaining valuable feedback and fostering potential collaborations.



KANNUR EDITION

'Startup 360' was held on February 23, 2024, at MiZone Kannur, offering enlightening sessions and dynamic discussions to help startups grow. The program provides comprehensive assistance to founders in all aspects of their entrepreneurial journey, with speakers and fellow entrepreneurs making the experience unforgettable.



STARTUP 360: PATHANAMTHITTA EDITION

Startup 360, held on March 23, 2024, at St. Thomas College, Ranni, Pathanamthitta, was a success, offering comprehensive support to founders in areas like business planning, technical design, legal requirements, financial management, and human resources. Participants had the opportunity to learn from esteemed experts including Jikku James, Head of Ideagora Startup Center at St. Thomas College, Ranni; C S Dhanya Paul, Company Secretary in Practice; and Dr. Sarin CR, Associate Lead of L&D at Quantiphi Analytics provided insights, facilitating networking, knowledge sharing, and skill development.



STARTUP 360: KOLLAM EDITION

At Startup 360, held on May 25, 2024, at Fatima Matha College in Kollam, we provided entrepreneurs with extensive support across all aspects of their entrepreneurial endeavors. The event's success was greatly enhanced by our exceptional Startup 360 Experts, who offered valuable insights and guidance to the participating businesses.



INDUSTRY ARTICLE



Mr. Jacob Joy
President - TiE Kerala

Catalyzing Growth: TiE Kerala's Vision for Kerala's Startup Ecosystem

In a recent development, I have assumed the role of President at TiE Kerala, marking a significant milestone in our organization's journey to foster entrepreneurship and innovation in the state. With our visionary leadership and strategic approach, we aim to propel TiE Kerala to new heights, playing a pivotal role in shaping Kerala's entrepreneurial ecosystem.

Under our stewardship, TiE Kerala is poised to lead the charge in driving ecosystem growth and fostering innovation in the region. With a strong emphasis on collaboration and partnership, TiE Kerala serves as a Kerala chapter of a global organization with a mission to foster entrepreneurship, encapsulated in the slogan "An Entrepreneur in Every Home."

As the President of TiE Kerala, I am supported by a dedicated team, and together, we bring a wealth of experience and expertise to the table. Having demonstrated our commitment to supporting entrepreneurship and driving economic growth in the region, our strategic vision for TiE Kerala revolves around three key pillars:

Empowering Entrepreneurs:

We recognize the importance of empowering entrepreneurs with the knowledge, resources, and networks they need to succeed. Through mentorship programs, workshops, and networking events, TiE Kerala under our leadership will provide budding entrepreneurs with the support they need to turn their ideas into successful ventures.

Fostering Collaboration:

Collaboration is at the heart of TiE Kerala's approach to ecosystem development. We believe that by fostering collaboration between startups, investors, and industry stakeholders, TiE Kerala can create a conducive environment

for innovation and growth. Through strategic partnerships with organizations like Kerala Startup Mission, TiE Kerala will leverage synergies and pool resources to drive ecosystem growth.

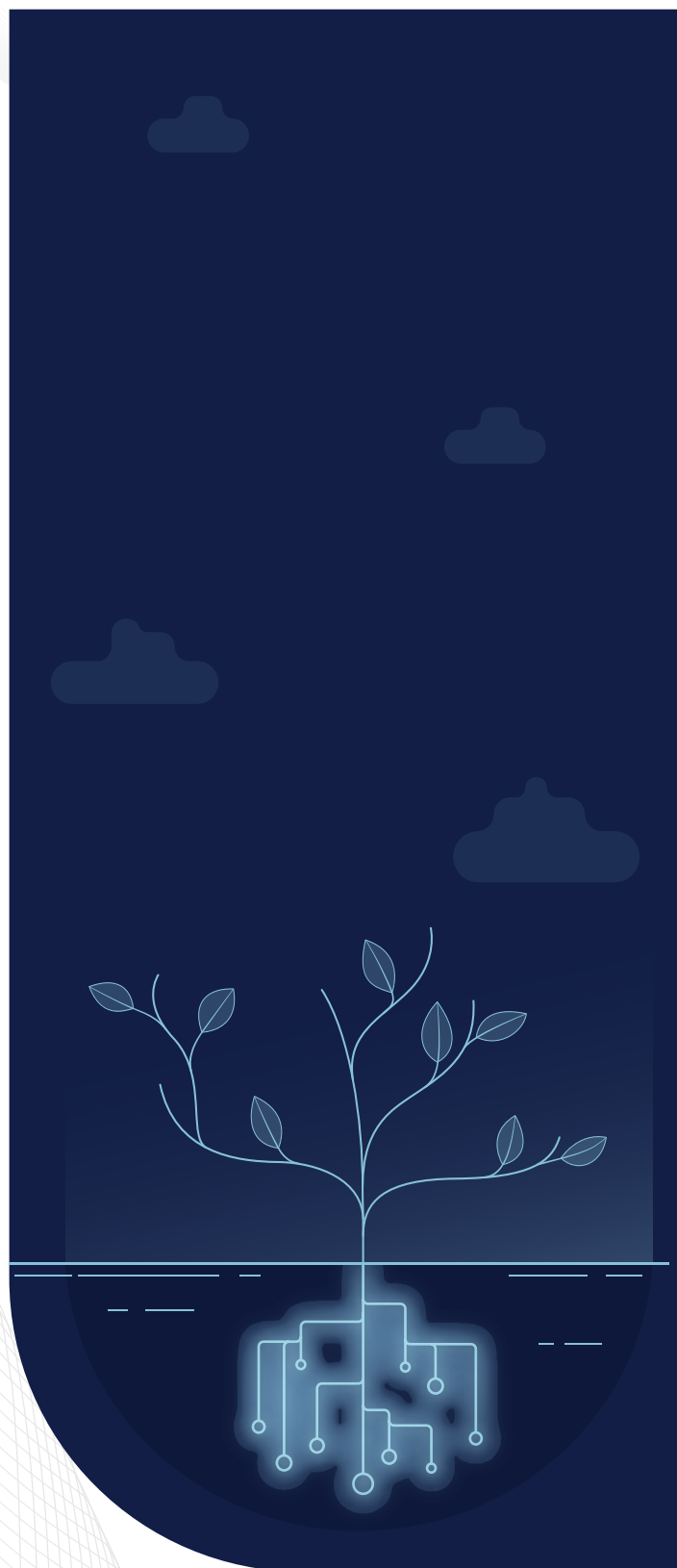
Driving Impact:

Ultimately, our goal for TiE Kerala is to drive tangible impact in the Kerala startup ecosystem. By facilitating meaningful connections, providing access to funding and mentorship, and advocating for policies that support entrepreneurship, TiE Kerala will play a leading role in shaping the future of Kerala's economy.

Project Diya:

One of our major initiatives, Project Diya, focuses on sectors such as Agriculture, Education, Health & Wellness, Assisted Living, and Research & Development. These sectors are covered in our flagship annual convention, TiEcon Kerala, where we bring together industry experts, investors, and entrepreneurs to explore opportunities, share insights, and drive innovation.

Kerala Startup Mission serves as a pivotal support system for TiE Kerala, collaborating closely with our team to advance the organization's regular activities and foster a diverse range of partnerships aimed at enriching Kerala's entrepreneurial landscape. Together, we form a dynamic alliance, empowering aspiring entrepreneurs and facilitating innovative ventures that drive sustainable growth within the state. With our steadfast commitment to excellence and innovation, TiE Kerala and our team are poised to lead the way towards new horizons, catalyzing growth, and fostering a culture of entrepreneurship that propels Kerala into a prosperous future.



WHAT'S NEW?



STARTUP ECOSYSTEM TRENDS

Starting a new business is always exciting, especially in this day and age when entrepreneurship is being transformed by rapid innovation. Due to several emerging trends, each with unique possibilities and challenges of its own, the startup ecosystem has undergone significant change in recent years.

In the dynamic realm of entrepreneurship, startup trends are a constant, mirroring shifts in customer demands, technological advancements, and societal norms. These trends have an impact on the trajectory of individual businesses as well as the broader startup ecosystem and the economy at large.

India has been a global center for innovation and entrepreneurship in recent years, encouraging government policies, a young and tech-savvy population, and a thriving startup ecosystem. Several trends are currently shaping the startup landscape in India, reflecting the country's unique opportunities and challenges.

Additionally, emerging technologies like Blockchain, Artificial intelligence (AI), Augmented Reality (AR), Virtual Reality (VR), and Robotic Process Automation (RPA) are being used by entrepreneurs. Startups can benefit from these technologies by automating procedures, boosting productivity, and enhancing client experiences. These technologies can also assist startups in developing fresh company strategies that may open up new avenues for expansion like chatGPT, Pika Labs and Xembly.

For startups, achieving sustainability is a significant challenge that calls for thoughtful preparation and innovative solutions. Startups may secure their long-term success and have a positive impact on a more sustainable future by staying up-to-date with the newest sustainability trends. Startups will face new sustainability difficulties as technology develops, but they may minimize their environmental impact while continuing to succeed by staying ahead of the curve and leveraging emerging technologies.



SUSTAINABILITY AND SOCIAL IMPACT

To reduce the influence on the environment, there has been a greater emphasis in recent years on cutting waste, saving energy, and increasing efficiency. More and more startups are looking into ways to lower their carbon footprint and relying on renewable energy sources. Furthermore, a lot of firms are putting sustainable methods into reality, such as recycling materials and developing business plans that emphasize cutting down on energy and waste.

Entrepreneurship centered around sustainability and social effect is becoming more popular as people become more conscious of environmental issues and social responsibility. These initiatives seek to solve urgent global issues like inequality, poverty, and climate change. Startups are using business concepts to transform the world while making money, from fair-trade goods to renewable energy solutions.



Startups must be more aware of their long-term objectives and strategies for maintaining their competitiveness in the face of the rapidly evolving business landscape and the speed at which technology is developing. This is especially true for sustainability, where startups need to stay on top of emerging trends and technology to stay competitive.

CHALLENGES FACED BY INDIAN STARTUPS

It can be difficult to launch a business in India, where regulatory barriers that entrepreneurs must surmount which include high taxes, stringent labor rules, and administrative burdens associated with getting licenses and permits. Startups find it challenging to grow and scale their operations due to these barriers, which can cost them both money and time.

Despite the strong interest from investors, getting money can still be difficult, particularly for early-stage businesses. For startups, navigating complicated rules and bureaucracy may be difficult, particularly in industries like finance and healthcare. In certain regions of India, there may be irregular access to dependable infrastructure, such as internet connectivity and logistics, which might impede business operations.

Growing a business while preserving quality and efficiency can be difficult, particularly for startups that operate in a variety of geographically scattered market places. It can be difficult for startups to stand out in India's fiercely competitive markets, where both domestic and foreign companies are fighting for market share. These challenges, however, also present opportunities for innovation and growth within the Indian startup ecosystem.

Startup trends are a constant in the ever-changing world of entrepreneurship, reflecting changes in consumer behavior, technology, and societal requirements. These patterns affect not only the course of individual companies but also the economy overall and the larger startup ecosystem. These patterns only scratch the surface of the vibrant and varied startup scene. Innovation will continue to be central to startup culture, propelling advancement and influencing the direction of business as entrepreneurs seek out new opportunities and challenges.



STARTUP SCHEMES

SCHEMES FOR STARTUPS TO BUILD AND SCALE UP

There are quite a few schemes which can be leveraged by startups to build and scale up their ventures. Some of these are offered by multinational giants while there is a pioneering innovation grants programme launched by the Government of Kerala. Following is a snapshot of some of the schemes:

PATENT REIMBURSEMENT

Kerala Government, through Kerala Startup Mission has launched a scheme called Patent Support Scheme, where support is provided for startups and student entrepreneurs who are able to secure a patent.

Patent Support System intends to support startup entrepreneurs and student entrepreneurs by reimbursing the patent cost including consultation fee, subject to a limit of Rs. 2 lakh per Indian patent awarded. For awarded foreign patents on a single subject matter, up to Rs. 10 lakh would be reimbursed. The reimbursement will be done in 3 stages during filing, prosecution and award.



178

APPLICATIONS

134

PATENTS REIMBURSED

1.43 CR

FUND RELEASED

ELIGIBILITY

- The patent applications which are filed only after 09.11.2015 will be considered.
- The patent support can be directly applied by Student Entrepreneurs through their IEDC's.
- For a startup, it should be a legal entity registered with RoC as Pvt Ltd or LLP. The schemes are not applicable to Innovators.
- The startup must be registered in Kerala, within 10 years from date of Incorporation and must have a DIPP and Udyog Aadhar.
- For students, the support will be given only for those who are pursuing the academics.
- The scheme does not extend support to patent renewals and prosecutions against appellate authority who have already rejected one's patent claims.

BENEFITS

- Rs.2 Lakhs/ Indian Patent
- Rs.10 Lakhs/International Patent
- Activity Covered are: Provisional Patents Filings, Patent Search, Drafting, Filings, Claims Preparations, Fast tracking Fees, Claims prosecutions, Granting
- Activities of Prosecution against Appellate Authorities who have already rejected your claims due to Valid reasons and Patent renewals are not covered.
- The scheme supports only patents, not trademarks, copyrights or any other Intellectual Property Rights



TECHNOLOGY TRANSFER & COMMERCIALIZATION SUPPORT SCHEME

Kerala Government, through Kerala Startup Mission has launched a scheme called Technology Transfer Scheme, startups who have purchased or sourced Technology License from any Government research Institution in India and are working on it to develop as a commercializable product. This scheme intends to support Technology License/Transfer Startups by providing a funding support of maximum of Rs.10 Lakhs in the form of reimbursement for the startups, who have paid to the Research Institution. However, the support is limited to 90% of the technology fee to be paid to the Research entity.

The terms & conditions for the benefits under the scheme will be as follows:

- The license/technology purchased through this scheme shall be owned by the Startup or as per the terms specified by the research agency.
- Kerala Startup Mission shall be given 2% royalty for the product being commercialized, which shall be limited to the amount supported by the Kerala Startup Mission under the scheme.
- The Startup is expected to commercialize the product for which the license /technology is purchased within a period of 2 years.
- In case, the Startup is unable to commercialize the product within two years, then the startup will be liable to repay the contribution given by the Kerala Startup Mission.
- The Startup will sign an agreement with the Kerala startup Mission before availing the benefit.

FOR STARTUPS THAT

- STEP 1 : Online Application
- STEP 2 : Document Submissions in hardcopies
- STEP 3 : Processing
- STEP 4 : Fund Release to Startup

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

- The startup should be a registered company in Kerala as an LLP or Pvt. Ltd company and should have an active registration with KSUM at the time of application.
- The startup company has DIPP registration and an 'Active'/'Active Compliant' status with MCA.
- The startups shall not have any other pending dues with any of the Government agencies, KSUM, Other incubators in the state and shall not be blacklisted by any Govt. agency in India

BENEFITS

- Technology License / Transfer support for Startups will be a maximum of Rs.10 Lakhs. However, the support is limited to 90% of the technology fee to be paid to the Research entity.

DOCUMENT CHECKLIST

- Original hard copy of Invoice & Receipt with authorized seal and signature from the research organization.
- Original Bank Statement showing amount transferred (Verified by Bank Manager).
- Technology Transfer Agreement with research organization. Residence Proof details of the director(s)/ applicant(s).
- Company incorporation documents (Incorporation Certificates, MoA, AoA, DIN nos).
- Undertaking that the startup has not so far claimed and will not claim any sort of reimbursement costs from any other organizations/ govt. bodies and if found, they will pay twice the amount to KSUM, that is reimbursed through Technology support scheme.
- Canceled Cheque of the company and Bank details (Branch name, IFSC Code).



STARTUP DPIIT RECOGNITION APPLICATION ON NATIONAL SINGLE WINDOW SYSTEM

Access over **610 Central Approvals** and **3879 State Approvals**

Explore, Apply and Get all the approvals required to start your business in India

Central Approvals | Search Approvals | EXPLORE ALL

Don't know which approvals are required? [Click Here & Know Your Approvals](#)

BENEFITS

How does NSWS help you?

The National Single Window System (NSWS) is a digital platform to guide you in identifying and applying for approvals according to your business requirements. The Know Your Approvals (KYA) module includes guidance for 32 Central Departments and 32 States. You are advised to check the relevant Government portals for any other required approvals. The portal hosts applications for approvals from 28 Central Departments and 20 State Governments. These approvals can be applied through NSWS.

All approvals in one place
Get everything you need in one place without having to go to individual Ministries, Departments or States.

Real-time status tracking
Get real-time updates on the status of your applications and plan your next steps with ease.

Secure document repository
Upload documents once and use them in all your applications.

Easy renewal
Renew your approvals easily through a seamless interface.

Fast query management
Get quick resolution to your queries from our dedicated team.

Know your approvals
Use the intelligent questionnaire to easily find out which approvals you might need for your business.

Connect with us from 3pm to 4pm, Monday- Friday for grievance/query redressal. Hear directly from National Single Window System technical team. [Click here to connect](#)

REGISTRATION AS A STARTUP

www.nsws.gov.in

FILL THE APPLICATION FORM

Click on > Apply Now > Common Registration Form > Startup Recognition by DPIIT

REGISTER ON STARTUP INDIA

www.startupindia.gov.in

DOWNLOAD THE CERTIFICATE

www.nsws.gov.in / www.startupindia.gov.in

KSUM UNIQUE ID REGISTRATION



■ FOR REGISTRATION

Visit www.startups.startupmission.in and click on the 'GET YOUR UNIQUE ID HERE' button.

■ APPLICATION FORM

Use your Startup India Credentials (credentials used to generate your DIPP Certificate)

■ REGISTRATION PROCESS

After login you will be redirected to the Unique ID application form. Fill in the required details and click the Submit button.

■ ID APPROVAL

After registration is successful it will take a maximum of three days for the approval by KSUM.

■ CERTIFICATE FROM KSUM

Companies should generate a certificate from their profile page to complete the registration process.

■ VERIFICATION OF DETAILS

Once the certificate is generated, Companies should visit www.startups.startupmission.in/web/certified_startups and search with their 'company' name to check whether the company is listed here.

Kerala has around 5400+ startups working in various sectors spread across its 14 districts. Our startups work in wide range of sectors including Artificial Intelligence, Hardware, Healthcare, Fin tech, Bio Technology etc.

Have a thought, comment or suggestion to share with us?

We'd love to hear from you.
Write to us at



info@startupmission.in



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